Institute, vol 48, in 1918, the custom was to all intents extinct.

7 B. Sobhhan, *Dewan Velu Thampi and the British*, 1978. See also *Travancore State Manual*.

8 Colin Macaulay, *Desultory notes on a cursory view of some papers extracted from the records of the East India House, which have been printed for the use of the Committee of the House of Commons, on the Travancore Petition, by Lieutenant General Macaulay*, 1832.

9 Lord Monson and G. L. Gower (eds), *Memoirs of George Elers, Captain of the 12th Regiment of Foot (1777–1842)*, 1903. See also Richard Cannon (ed.), *Historical record of the 12th, or the East Suffolk, Regiment of Foot, containing an account of the formation of the Regiment in 1685, and of its subsequent services to 1847*, 1848.

10 Quoted in P. S. Menon, *A history of Travancore from its earliest times*, 1878.

11 Col. John Munro in a letter to the Madras Government dated 7 March 1818, quoted in *Appendix to the report from the select committee of the House of Commons on the affairs of the East India Company*, 1832.

12 R. N. Yesudas, *Colonel John Munro in Travancore*, 1977; see also W. Hamilton, *A geographical, statistical and historical account of Hindostan and other adjacent countries*, 1820.

13 Travancore State was in no way exceptional in recognising slavery as an institution. In a note on slavery in his Madras Presidency Census Report of 1871, the Census Commissioner pointed out that throughout the Presidency ‘the whole of the Pariah community without exception were the slaves of the superior castes’ and that ‘almost all the inferior agricultural tribes were in a similar position’. Fifteen forms of slavery were officially recognised under Hindu law, and Brahmins, categorically, could never be slaves. The EICo was the first government in India to ban the buying and selling of